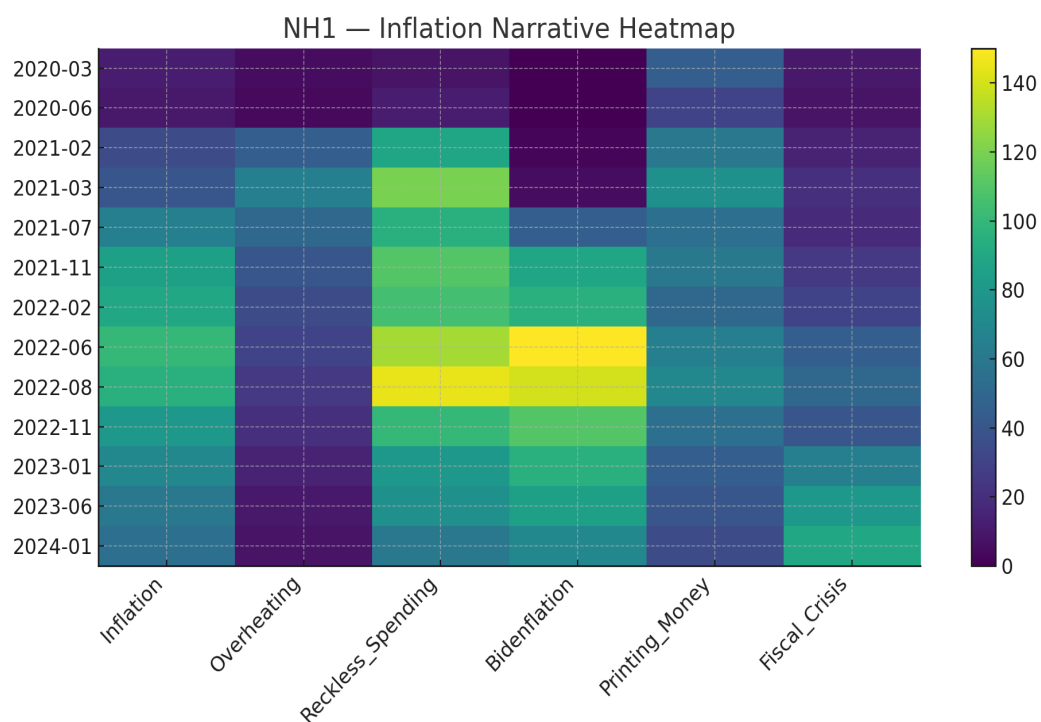


Narrative Heatmaps — Evidence Packet (Updated)

These visuals show when specific political stories suddenly became popular in Congress or the media. Bright colors represent moments when certain words were used far more often than usual.

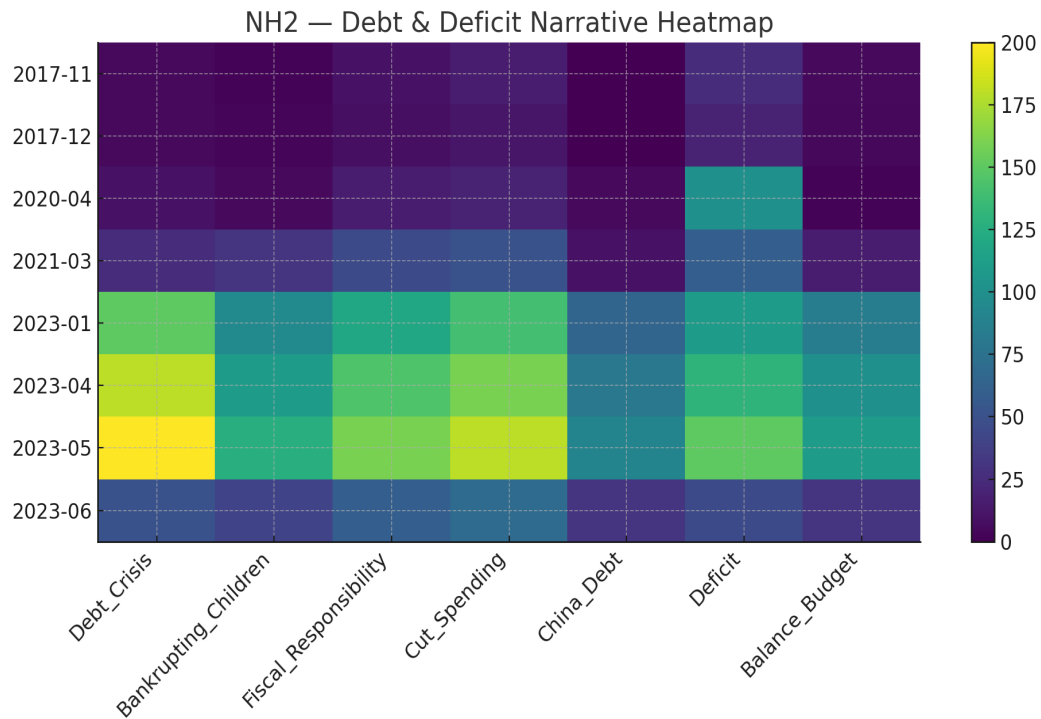
NH1 — Inflation Narrative Heatmap

Inflation-related phrases surge sharply in 2021 and 2022, especially as CPI hit multi-decade highs. Terms like “Bidenflation” and “reckless spending” peak around June–August 2022.



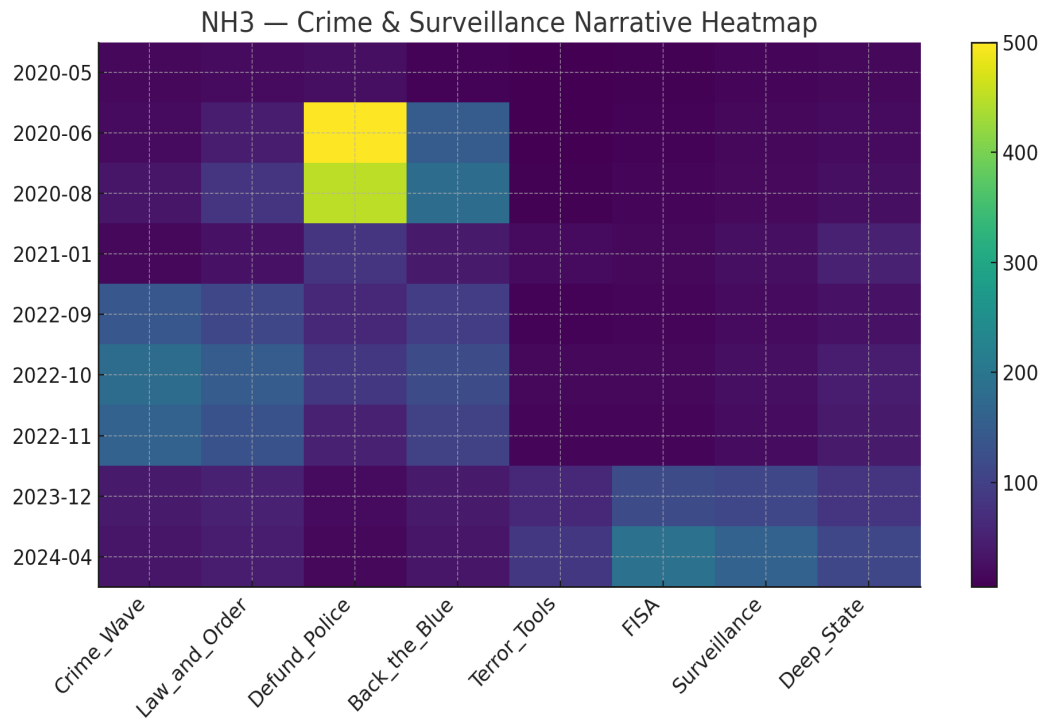
NH2 — Debt & Deficit Narrative Heatmap

Debt rhetoric spikes dramatically in 2023 during debt ceiling negotiations. Mentions of “debt crisis,” “cut spending,” and “fiscal responsibility” shoot upward compared to earlier years.



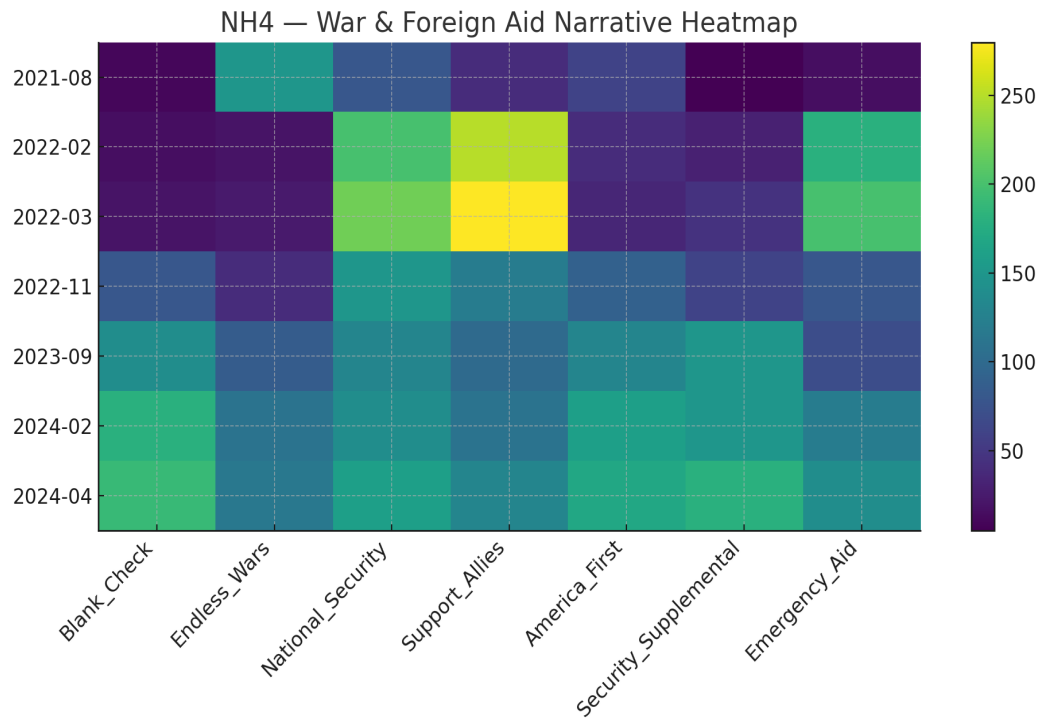
NH3 — Crime, Policing & Surveillance Narrative Heatmap

In 2020, “defund the police” dominates public conversation. Years later, the focus shifts toward “crime wave” narratives during the midterm cycle, then toward surveillance-related conflicts like FISA in 2023–2024.



NH4 — War, Foreign Aid & Military Spending Narrative Heatmap

Support for allies spikes sharply in early 2022 at the start of the Ukraine conflict. Later, competing narratives about “blank checks,” “endless wars,” and “America First” become dominant as funding debates intensify.



Summary

Heatmaps help expose when political stories intensify dramatically. These timing patterns often align with major hearings, elections, or legislative fights — revealing when narratives are used strategically rather than consistently.